

L06: CNN Architectures & Transfer Learning

FICT, UTAR

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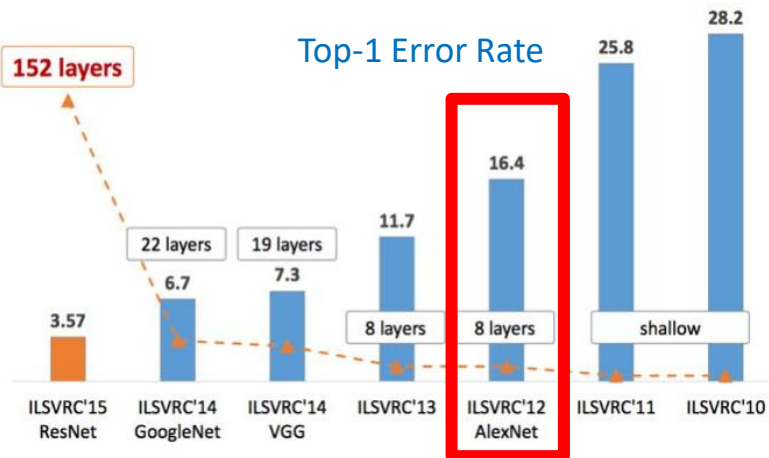
1. Network Architectures:
 - AlexNet
 - VGGNet
 - ResNet
 - ResNeXt
 - MobileNet
2. Transfer Learning
3. Applications
 - Face Recognition

Network Architecture: **AlexNet**

AlexNet (2012)

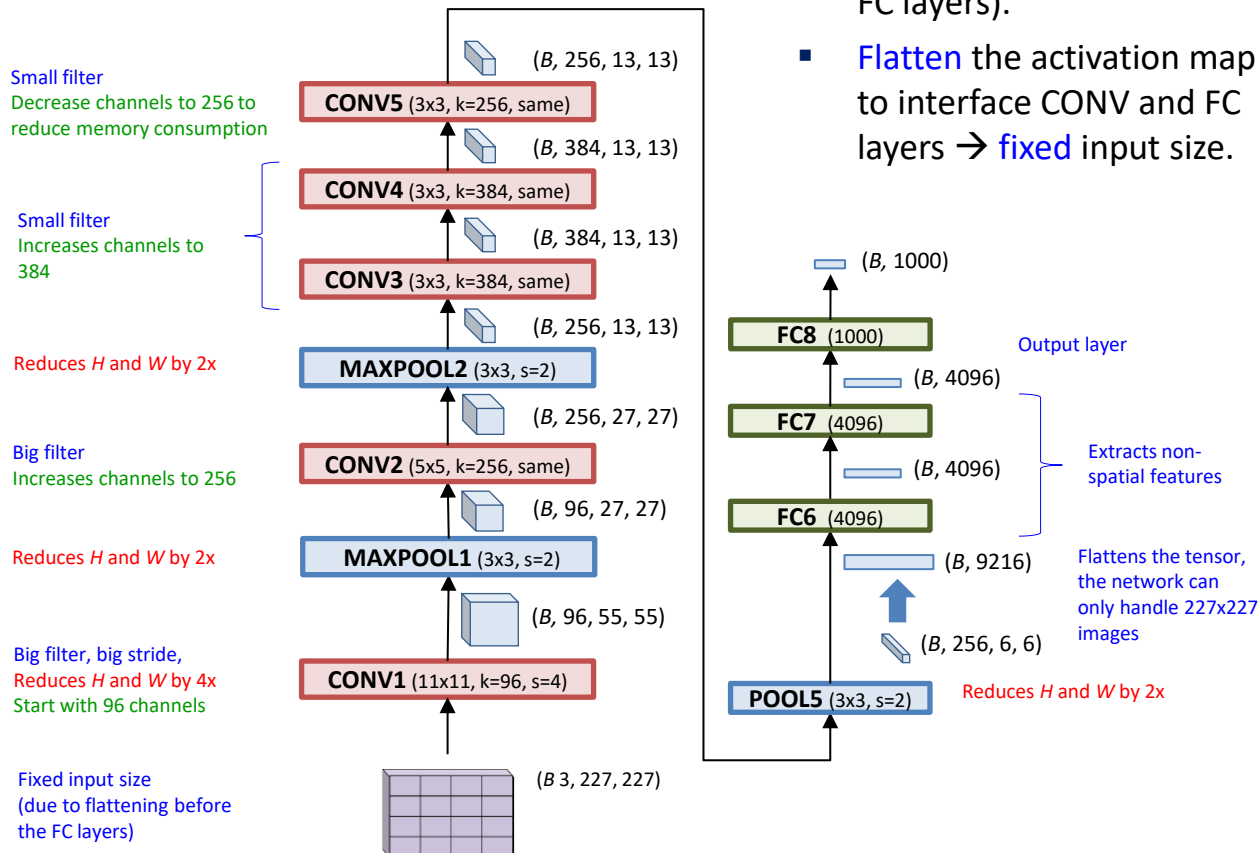
[Krizhevsky, A., Sutskever, I. and Hinton, G.E., Imagenet classification with deep convolutional neural networks. NIPS2012]

- Winner of ILSVRC-2012 competition for object classification & localization



- Jaw-dropping performance (top-1 error: 16.4%, top-5 error 15.3%)
- Beats all hand-crafted method (2nd best: top-5 error: 26.2%)
- Triggered the deep learning revolution in Computer Vision
- Utilizes many techniques that are still used today

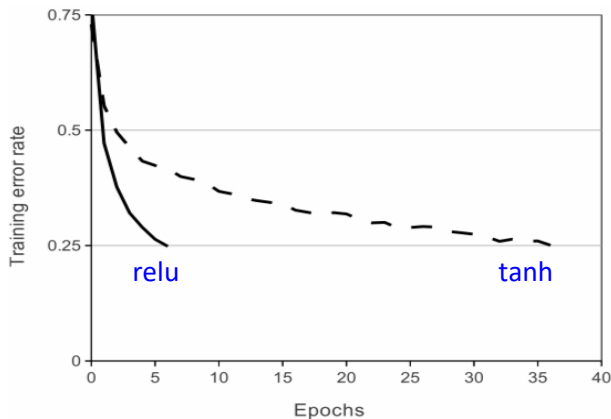
AlexNet Architecture



- Total: **8 layers** (5 CONV + 3 FC layers).
- **Flatten** the activation map to interface CONV and FC layers → **fixed** input size.

Useful Practices from AlexNet

- First use of **ReLU** activation (6 times faster than tanh)



- Training
 - Optimizer: **Stochastic Gradient Descent** with **momentum** ($\beta=0.9$)
 - Multiple **GPUs** to train efficiently (#gpus = 2)
 - Learning rate decay** (set $\alpha_0 = 0.01$, divide by 10 when validation stops improving, 3x prior to termination)

Useful Practices from AlexNet

- Regularization:
 - Applies **dropout** after CONV1 and CONV2 ($p=0.5$) – reduces overfitting but double # epoch to converge
 - **Data augmentation** to increase the training set by a factor of 2048 (random crop, random flip, color jitter)
 - **Weight decay** or L2 regularization (weight decay = 0.0005)
- Inference:
 - 10-crop testing (mean inference result on 10 cropped locations)
 - 7 CNN **Ensemble** reduces error from 18.2% to 15.4%

Issues with AlexNet

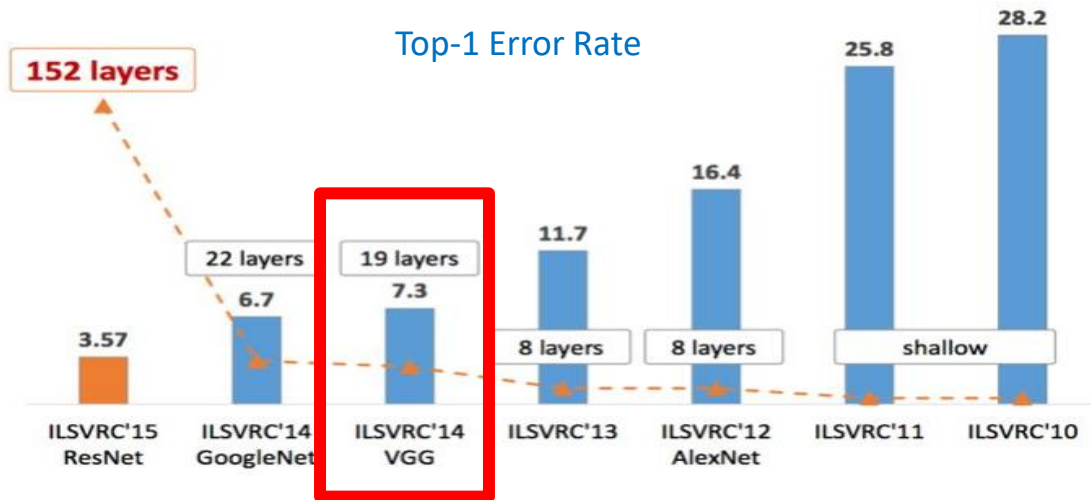
- **Not deep**: 8 layers only.
 - Use of big filters and strides.
 - Less powerful by today's standard.
 - Huge number of parameters.
- Design is **not regular**.
 - Configuration of the layers varies in each layer (different f and s).
 - Size of the activation maps varies in each layer.

Network Architecture: **VGGNet**

VGGNet (2015)

Simonyan, K., & Zisserman, A. (2015). Very deep convolutional networks for large-scale image recognition. 3rd International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR 2015), 1–14.

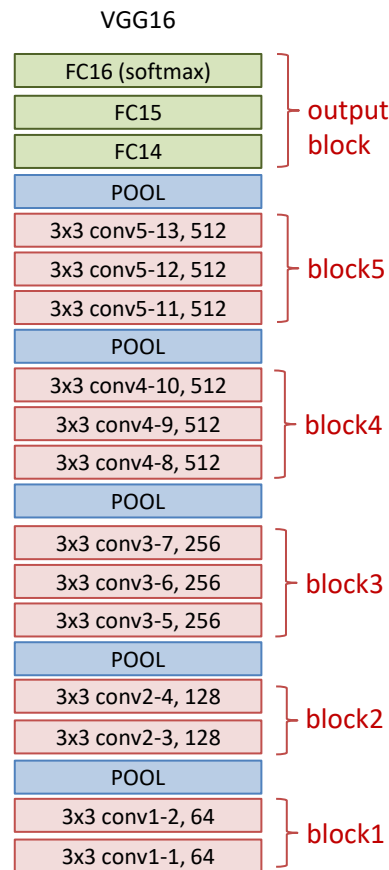
- ILSVRC 2014: Runner-up for classification task in ILSVRC2014



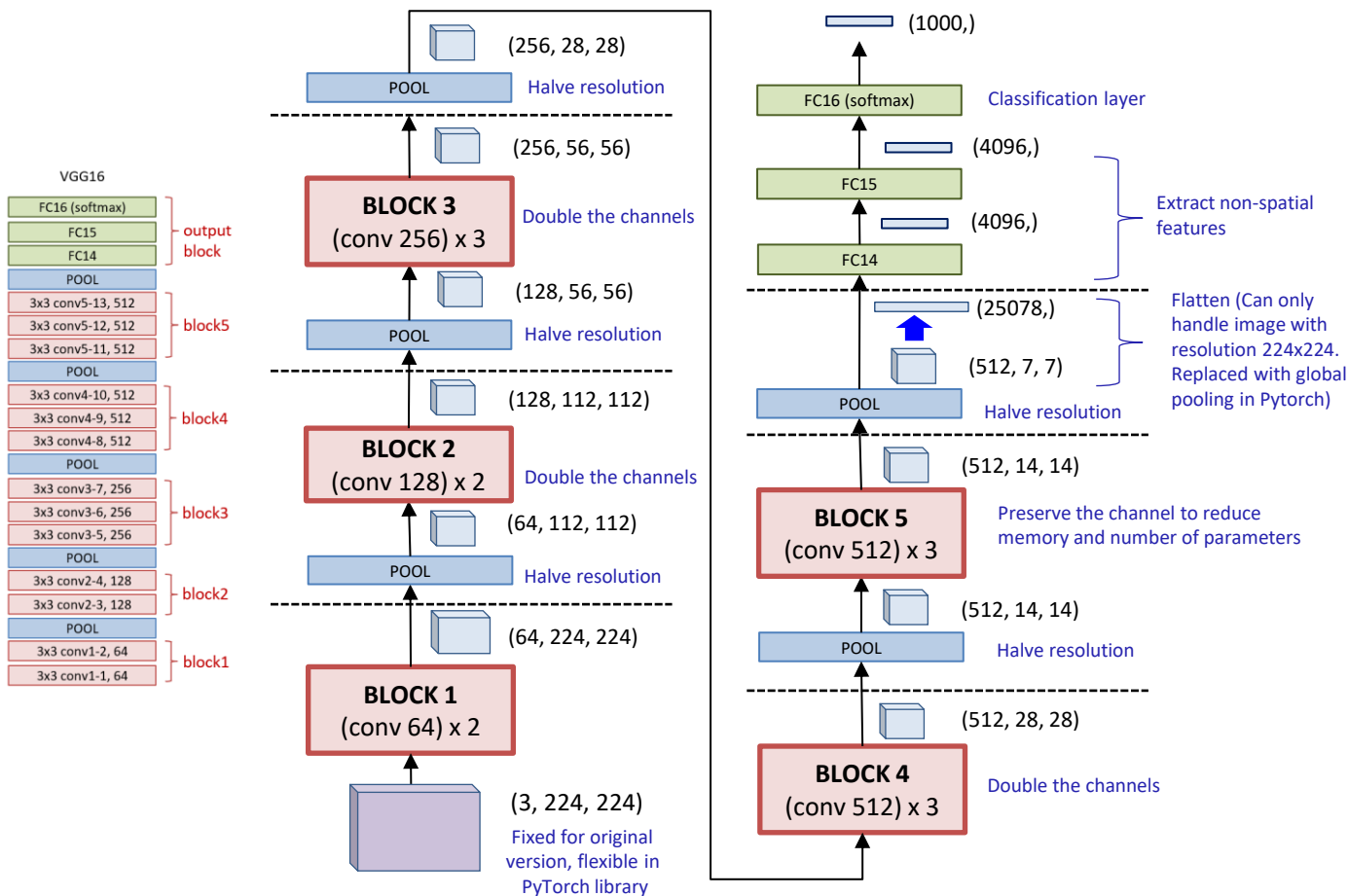
Top-5 error rate of 5.1% (Recall AlexNet: 15.3%)

Design Philosophies of VGGNet

- **Deeper** network (compared to AlexNet)
 - 16 and 19 layers
- Regular and principled design:
 - ✓ Only **small filter** (3x3)
 - ✓ Layers are organized into homogeneous **blocks** (activation map has same resolution)
 - ✓ Use **pooling** (not conv) to reduce spatial dimension
 - ✓ When the **resolution** is reduced by half, **number of channels** is doubled



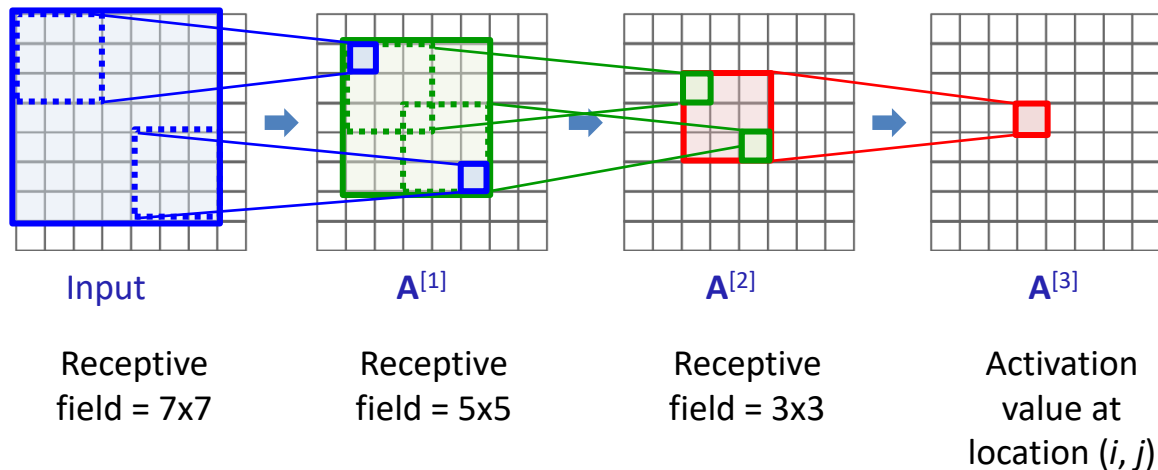
VGG-16 Architecture



Receptive Field

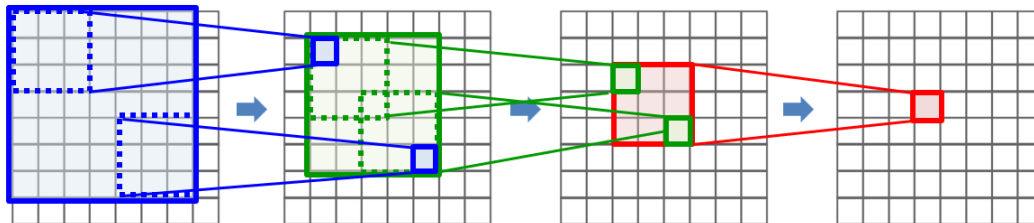
- 3x3 filters is small. Can it detect patterns at larger scales?

Yes. The receptive field increases with depth. **Receptive field** refers to the resolution of the region of a lower layer that is used to compute an activation value at a particular layer.

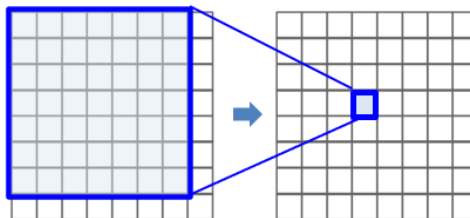


Filter size and depth

- **Smaller** filters can achieve the same receptive field as a **big** filter by having more layers:
- Example:
 - Conv 3x3 needs 3 layers to achieve a receptive field of 7x7 at the input layer.

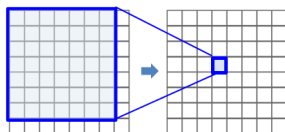


- Conv 7x7 needs 1 layers to achieve a receptive field of 7x7.

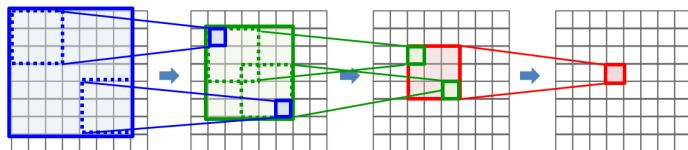


Slimmer but deeper network

- Deeper networks have more activation functions which enables it to model more complex functions.



1 ReLU activation



3 ReLU activations

- Less #parameters, hence easier to train.

Assume that all layers have c_{out} filters and c_{in} input channels:

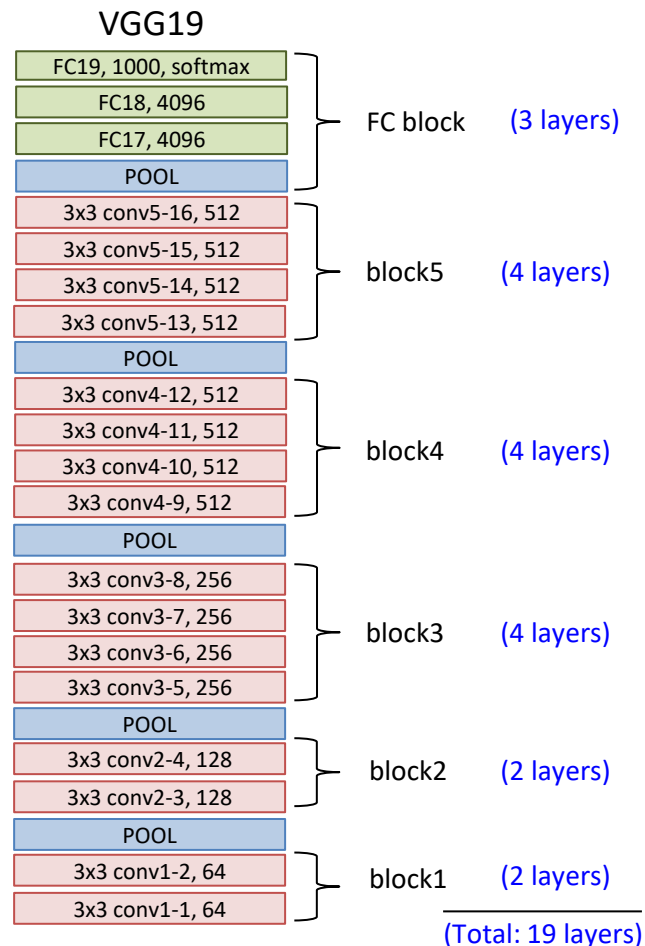
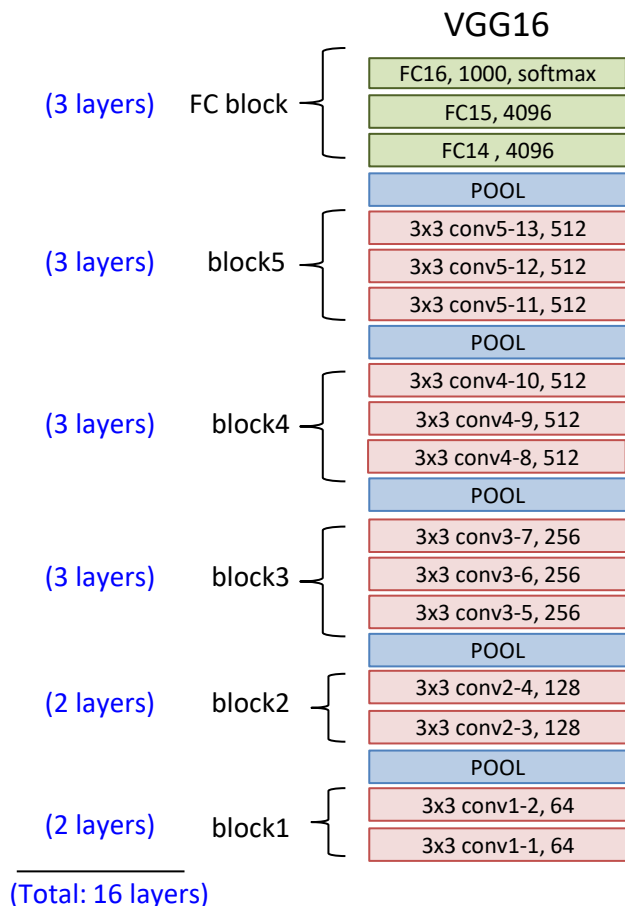
$\#param_{f=7}$

$$\begin{aligned} &= (7 \times 7 \times c_{in} + 1) \times c_{out} \times 1 \text{ layer} \\ &= 49c_{out}c_{in} + k \end{aligned}$$

$\#param_{f=3}$

$$\begin{aligned} &= (3 \times 3 \times c_{in} + 1) \times c_{out} \times 3 \text{ layers} \\ &= 27c_{out}c_{in} + 3k \\ &\text{(Only 55\% of larger filter)} \end{aligned}$$

Variants of VGGNet



#Parameters and memory consumption

INPUT: (3,224,224)	memory: $224*224*3=150K$	weights : 0
CONV3-64: (64,224,224)	memory: $224*224*64=3.2M$	weights: $(3*3*3)*64 = 1,728$
CONV3-64: (64,224,224)	memory: $224*224*64=3.2M$	weights: $(3*3*64)*64 = 36,864$
POOL2: (64,112,112)	memory: $112*112*64=800K$	weights : 0
CONV3-128: (128,112,112)	memory: $112*112*128=1.6M$	weights : $(3*3*64)*128 = 73,728$
CONV3-128: (128,112,112)	memory: $112*112*128=1.6M$	weights : $(3*3*128)*128 = 147,456$
POOL2: (128,56,56)	memory: $56*56*128=400K$	weights : 0
CONV3-256: (256,56,56)	memory: $56*56*256=800K$	weights : $(3*3*128)*256 = 294,912$
CONV3-256: (256,56,56)	memory: $56*56*256=800K$	weights : $(3*3*256)*256 = 589,824$
CONV3-256: (256,56,56)	memory: $56*56*256=800K$	weights : $(3*3*256)*256 = 589,824$
POOL2: (256,28,28)	memory: $28*28*256=200K$	weights : 0
CONV3-512: (512,28,28)	memory: $28*28*512=400K$	weights : $(3*3*256)*512 = 1,179,648$
CONV3-512: (512,28,28)	memory: $28*28*512=400K$	weights : $(3*3*512)*512 = 2,359,296$
CONV3-512: (512,28,28)	memory: $28*28*512=400K$	weights : $(3*3*512)*512 = 2,359,296$
POOL2: (512,14,14)	memory: $14*14*512=100K$	weights : 0
CONV3-512: (512,14,14)	memory: $14*14*512=100K$	weights : $(3*3*512)*512 = 2,359,296$
CONV3-512: (512,14,14)	memory: $14*14*512=100K$	weights : $(3*3*512)*512 = 2,359,296$
CONV3-512: (512,14,14)	memory: $14*14*512=100K$	weights : $(3*3*512)*512 = 2,359,296$
POOL2: (512,7,7)	memory: $7*7*512=25K$	weights : 0
FC: (4096,)	memory: 4096	weights : $7*7*512*4096 = 102,760,448$
FC: (4096,)	memory: 4096	weights : $4096*4096 = 16,777,216$
FC: (1000,)	memory: 1000	weights : $4096*1000 = 4,096,000$
TOTAL memory: $24M * 4 \text{ bytes} \sim 96MB$ / image (only forward! ~ 2 for bwd)		
TOTAL weights: 138M		

Most memory consumption at the early CONV layers

Most params are at the FC layer(difficult to train). PyTorch replaces this with global pooling

Very heavy memory usage
~0.2 GB for each image. For a GPU with 8GB, can only support up to a batch size of 40 images

Many parameters (AlexNet only has 60M)

Weakness of VGGNet

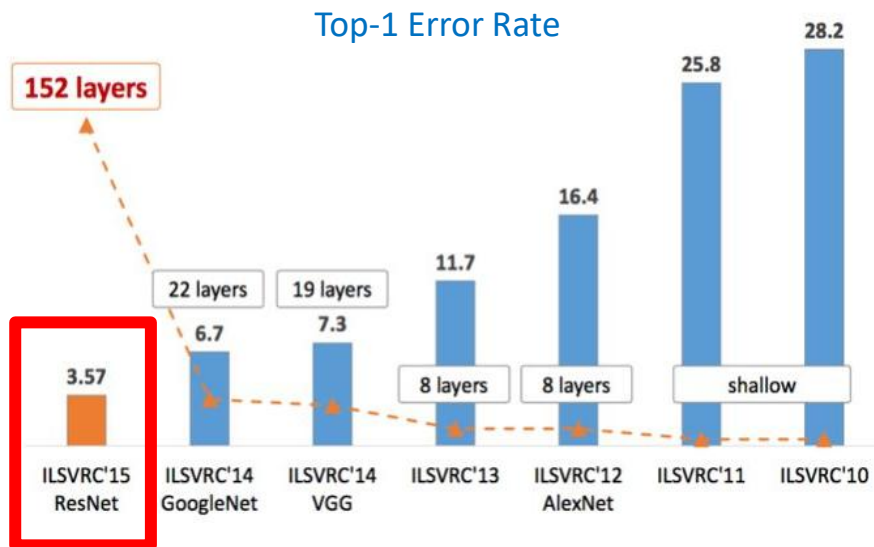
- Slow to train
- Huge number of parameters to train
- High memory consumption

Network Architecture: **ResNet**

Residual Network (ResNet)

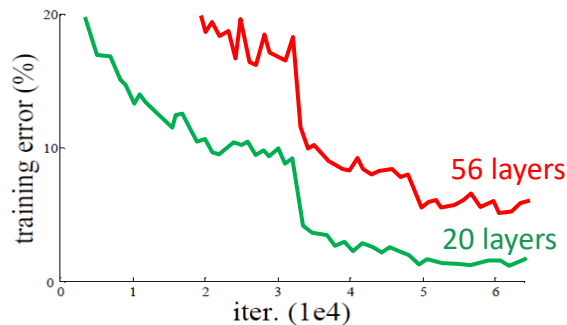
He, K., Zhang, X., Ren, S. and Sun, J., 2016. Deep residual learning for image recognition. In *Proceedings of the IEEE conference on computer vision and pattern recognition* (pp. 770-778).

- Winner for classification, localization and detection tasks (all tasks) in ILSVRC2015

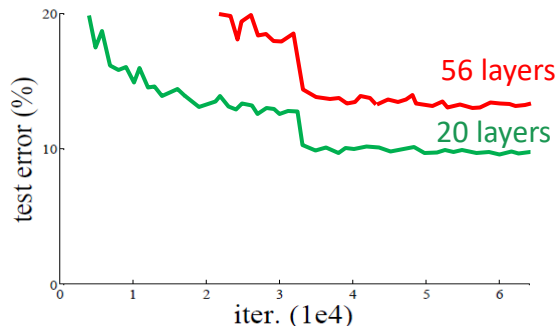


Motivation for Residual Network

- What is the issue with the result below?



Training error on CIFAR-10

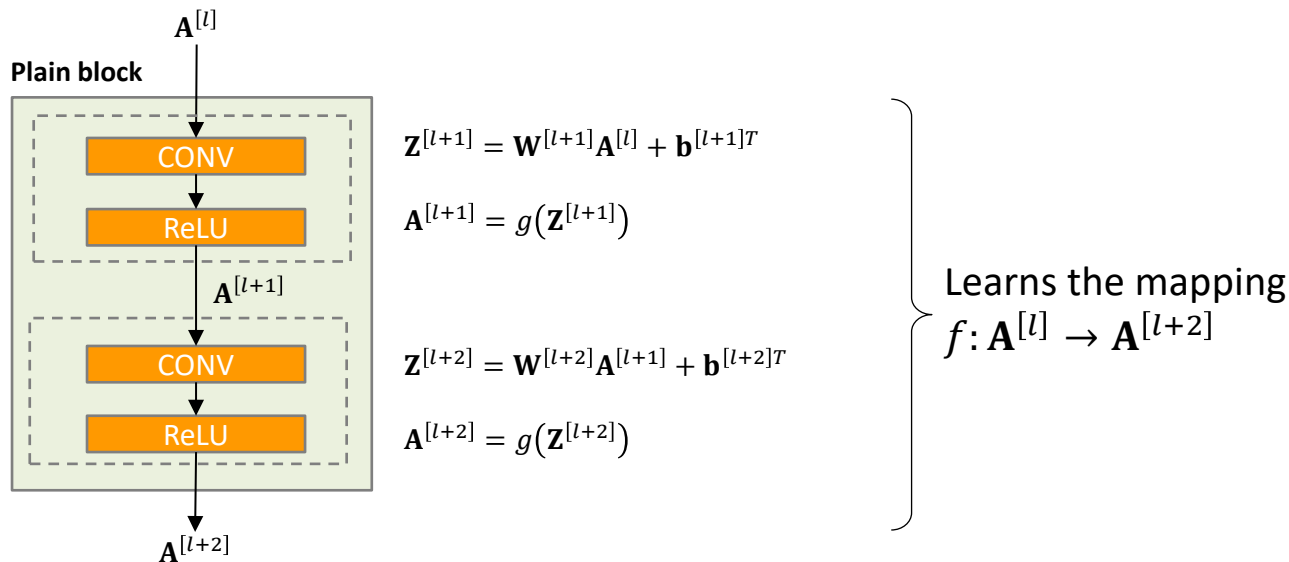


Testing error on CIFAR-10

- Both higher training and testing error for the deeper network → **Not** caused by **overfitting** (if yes, the deeper network would have a lower training error)
- High training and test error → difficulty training deeper networks caused by **vanishing gradient effect**

Plain Block is learning a mapping function (hard)

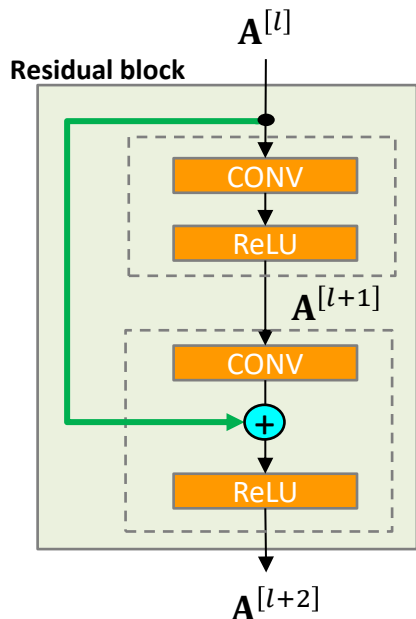
- The **plain block** (two layers) is learning a mapping function



- Difficult for a **mapping function** to learn certain functions, e.g., the identity function $\mathbf{A}^{[l+2]} = f(\mathbf{A}^{[l]}) = \mathbf{A}^{[l]}$

Residual Block

- **Residual block** = plain block with **short-cut** or **skip** connection.
- Learn a **residual function** instead of a mapping function.
- The skip connection allows the network to pass earlier information deeper into the layer.



$$\mathbf{Z}^{[l+1]} = \mathbf{W}^{[l+1]} \mathbf{A}^{[l]} + \mathbf{b}^{[l+1]T}$$

$$\mathbf{A}^{[l+1]} = g(\mathbf{Z}^{[l+1]})$$

$$\mathbf{Z}^{[l+2]} = \mathbf{W}^{[l+2]} \mathbf{A}^{[l+1]} + \mathbf{b}^{[l+2]T}$$

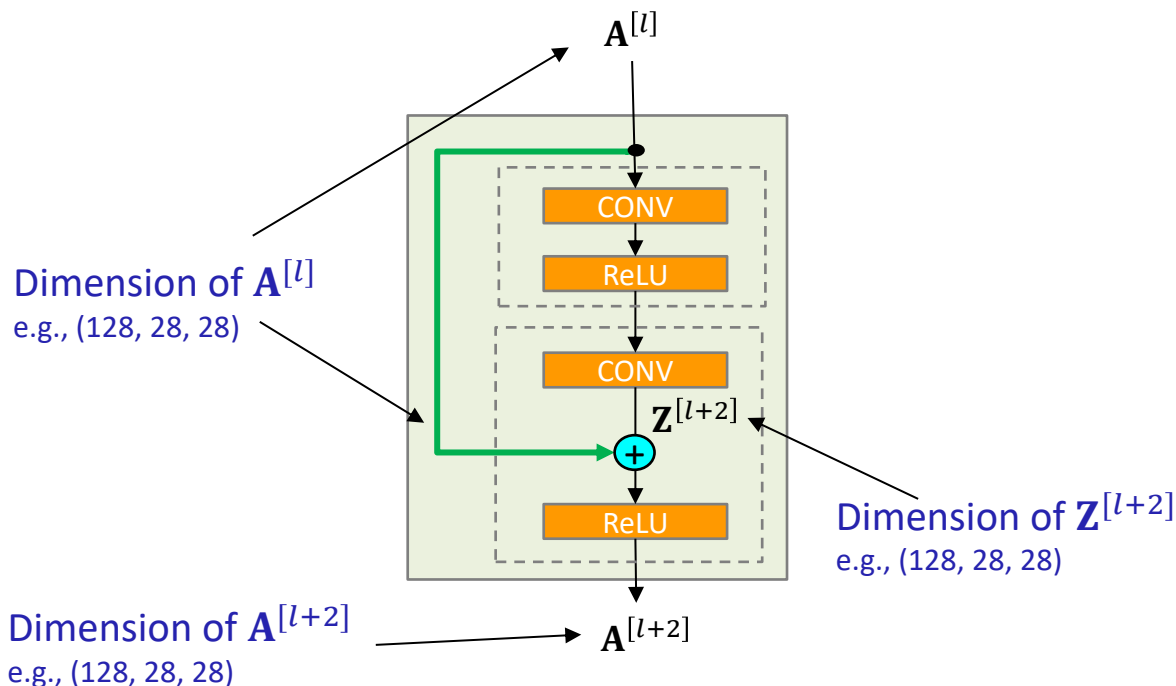
$$\mathbf{A}^{[l+2]} = g(\mathbf{Z}^{[l+2]} + \mathbf{A}^{[l]})$$

Learns the **offset** or **residual** $\mathbf{Z}^{[l+2]} = r(\mathbf{A}^{[l]})$

Pre-activation is computed by **adding** the computed offset
 $\mathbf{Z}^{[l+2]} = r(\mathbf{A}^{[l]})$

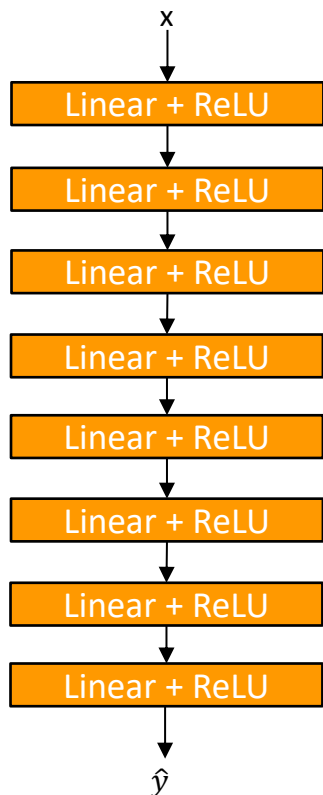
Dimension of the Residual Block

- The inputs to the residual add function $\mathbf{A}^{[l]}$ and $\mathbf{Z}^{[l+2]}$ must have the same dimension.

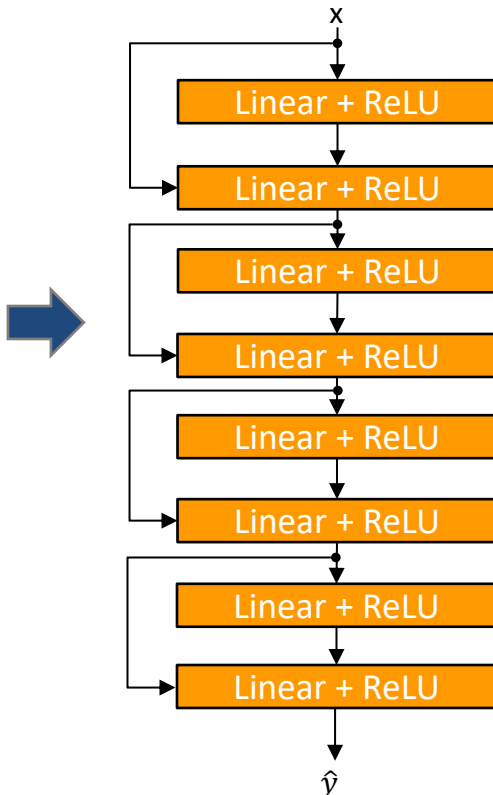


Transforming Plain Network to Residual Network

Plain Network



Residual Network

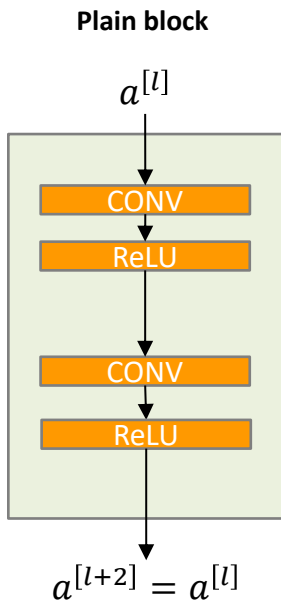


Residual network is built by adding skip connections onto a Plain Network

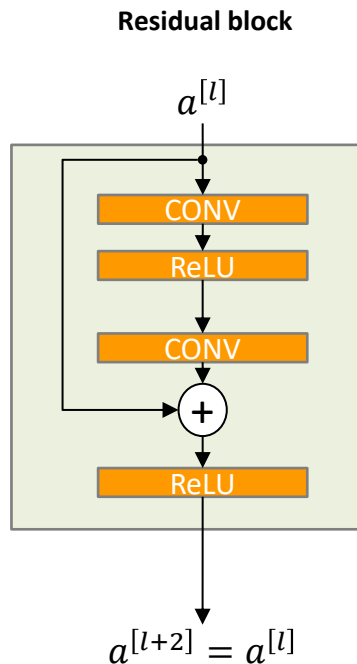
Why Residual Block?

- **Easier** to learn a residual function than a mapping function

Example: let's say we want to learn an identity function $a^{[l+2]} = a^{[l]}$



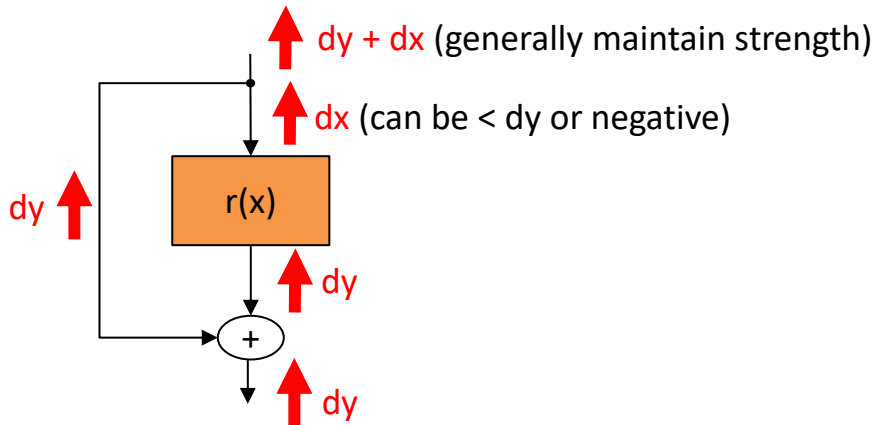
Difficult to learn the identity function $f(a^{[l]}) = a^{[l]}$



Easy to learn the residual function $r(a^{[l]}) = 0$

Why Residual Block?

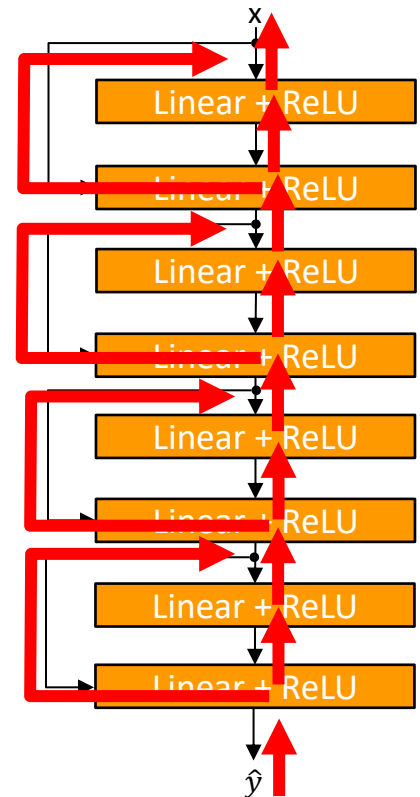
- Solves the **vanishing gradient** issue. The short-cut connections provide an **uninterrupted** path for backpropagating the gradient



add operation is a gradient distributor

branch is a gradient accumulator

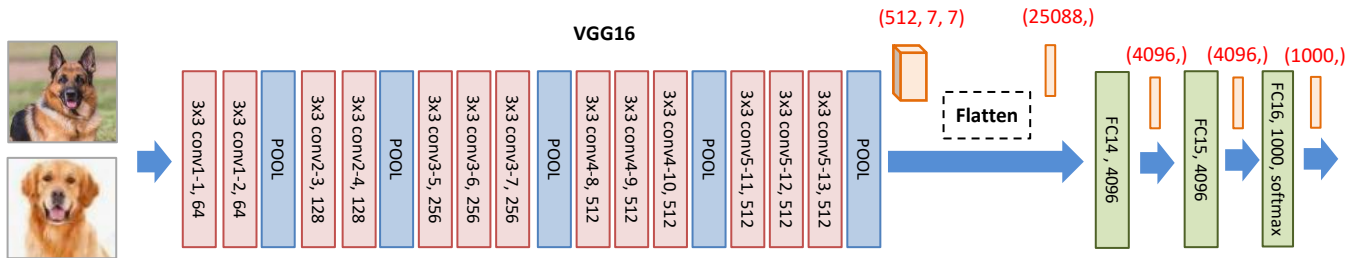
Residual Network



Output Layer Design

- Recap: AlexNet and VGGNet use **flattening** layer and **3 FC** layers.
- Issues with using flattening layer:

Issue 2: Is it really necessary to have multiple FC layers? Not really!

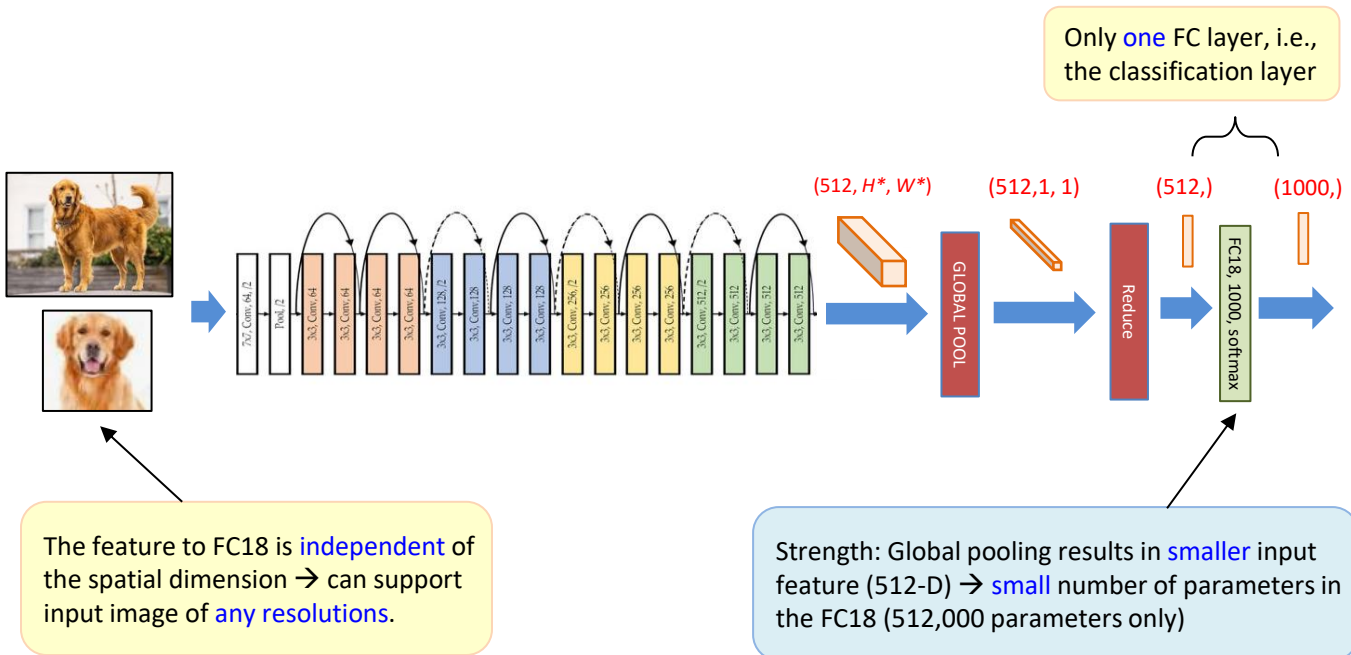


Issue 3: The feature to FC14 is fixed at 25088 dimensions → Input image must have a shape of (3, 224, 224)

Issue 1: Flattening results in high dimensional vector → huge number of parameters in FC14 (102,760,448 or ~74% of all parameters)

Output Layer Design

- ResNet uses **global pooling** as the interface between CONV and FC layers.
- Only **one** fully connected layer in the output block.



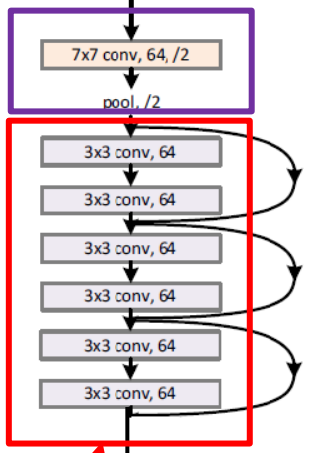
Design Principles of ResNet

- Adopts the homogeneous design principle of VGG.
 - Mostly have 3x3 filters.
 - Layers within the same block has the same configuration and resolution.
 - When resolution is halved, number of channels is doubled to preserve the complexity per layer.
- Downsampling is performed directly by convolutional layers with a stride of 2.
- Efficient output block design
 - Uses global average pooling to interface between the CONV and FC blocks
 - Only one FC layer
 - Small number of parameters and memory consumption
 - Less overfitting issues

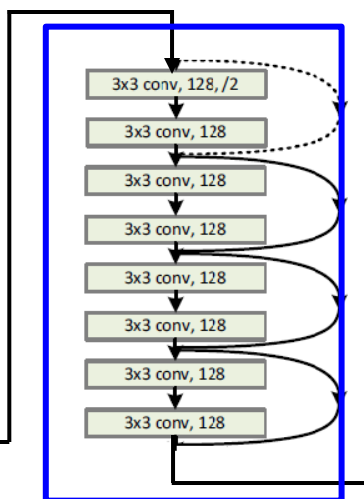
ResNet Architecture (ResNet34)

Assume: 224×224

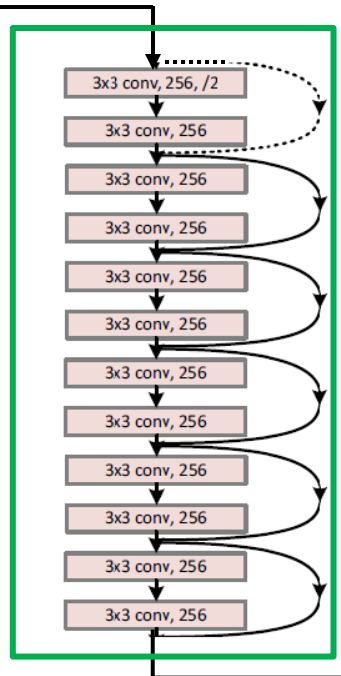
image Stem
Network



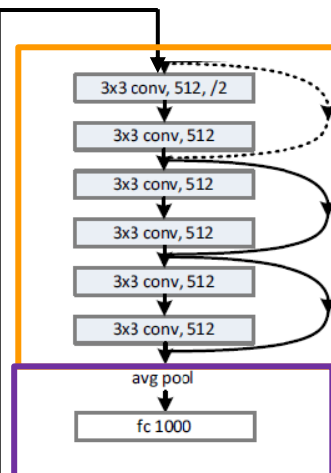
BLOCK 2
 $C_{out} = 128$ filters
resolution: 28×28



BLOCK 3
 $C_{out} = 256$ filters
resolution: 14×14



BLOCK 4
 $C_{out} = 512$ filters
resolution: 7×7



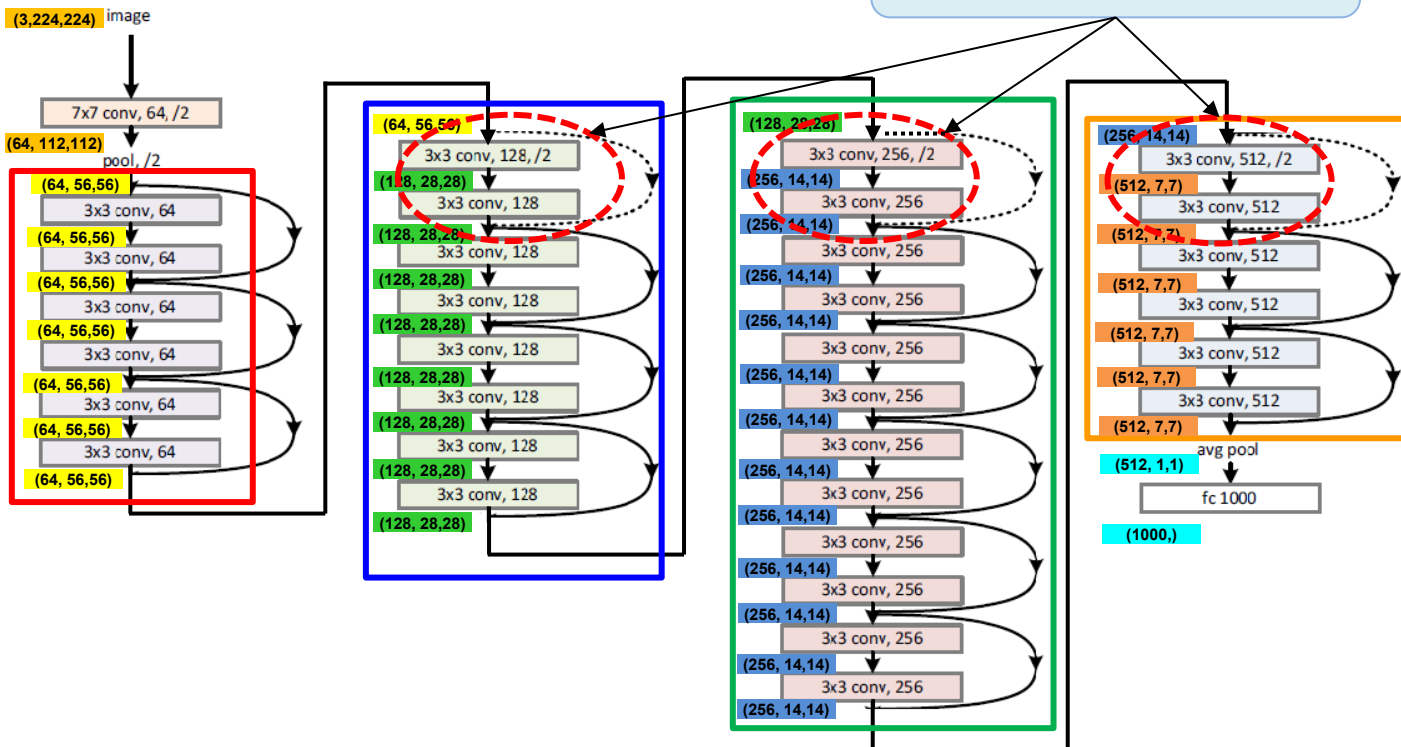
Classification block

BLOCK 1
 $C_{out} = 64$ filters
resolution: 56×56

Dimensions of activation maps and features

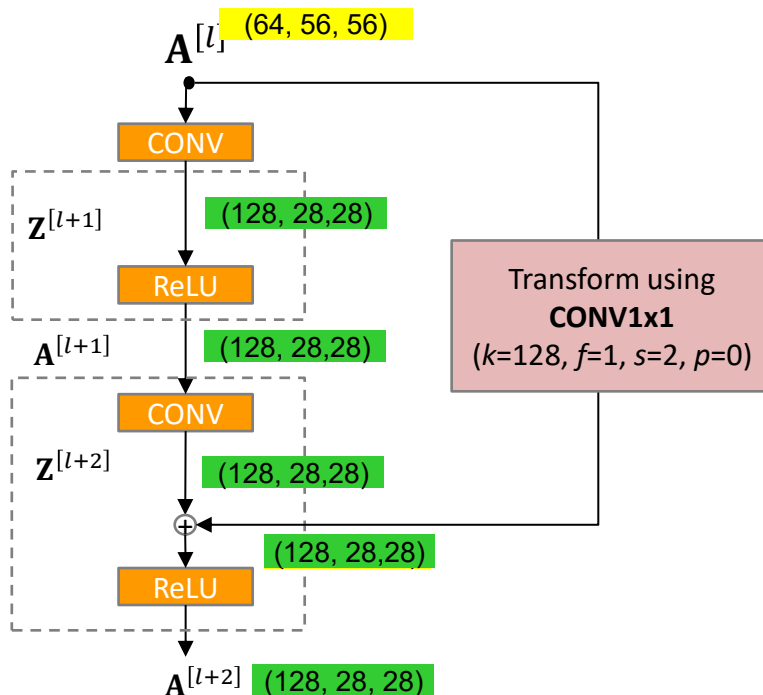
- Given an image with resolution 224x224:

The dimensions of the signals in the first residual block is inconsistent



Design of the First Residual Block

- If the depth of $\mathbf{A}^{[l]}$ and $\mathbf{Z}^{[l+2]}$ are different, perform 1x1 convolution with stride = 2 and $c_{\text{out}} = 2 * c_{\text{in}}$.

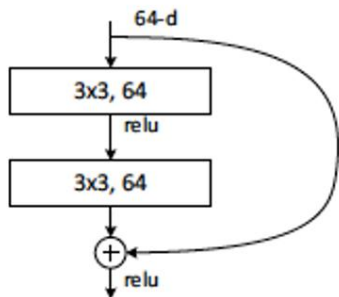


Basic vs Bottleneck Residual Block

- To reduce computation time and number of parameters, use a **bottleneck** design to design the building block for deeper versions of ResNet (50, 101 and 152).

Basic building block

(Used in ResNet-18, 34)



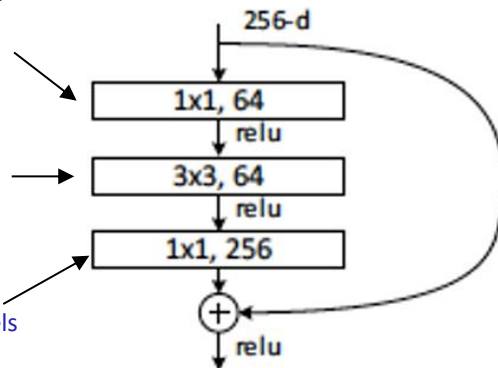
CONV1x1 **shrinks** the channels from 256 to 64 to reduce the input activation map for 3x3

CONV 3x3 **extracts feature** on a smaller input with 64 rather than 256 channels (more efficient)

CONV1x1 **expands** the channels back to 256 to preserve the input dimension

Bottleneck building block

(Used in ResNet-50, 101, 152)



Variants of ResNet

Assume input resolution is (224, 224)

layer name	output size	18-layer	34-layer	50-layer	101-layer	152-layer
conv1	112×112	7×7, 64, stride 2				
		3×3 max pool, stride 2				
conv2_x	56×56	$\begin{bmatrix} 3 \times 3, 64 \\ 3 \times 3, 64 \end{bmatrix} \times 2$	$\begin{bmatrix} 3 \times 3, 64 \\ 3 \times 3, 64 \end{bmatrix} \times 3$	$\begin{bmatrix} 1 \times 1, 64 \\ 3 \times 3, 64 \\ 1 \times 1, 256 \end{bmatrix} \times 3$	$\begin{bmatrix} 1 \times 1, 64 \\ 3 \times 3, 64 \\ 1 \times 1, 256 \end{bmatrix} \times 3$	$\begin{bmatrix} 1 \times 1, 64 \\ 3 \times 3, 64 \\ 1 \times 1, 256 \end{bmatrix} \times 3$
conv3_x	28×28	$\begin{bmatrix} 3 \times 3, 128 \\ 3 \times 3, 128 \end{bmatrix} \times 2$	$\begin{bmatrix} 3 \times 3, 128 \\ 3 \times 3, 128 \end{bmatrix} \times 4$	$\begin{bmatrix} 1 \times 1, 128 \\ 3 \times 3, 128 \\ 1 \times 1, 512 \end{bmatrix} \times 4$	$\begin{bmatrix} 1 \times 1, 128 \\ 3 \times 3, 128 \\ 1 \times 1, 512 \end{bmatrix} \times 4$	$\begin{bmatrix} 1 \times 1, 128 \\ 3 \times 3, 128 \\ 1 \times 1, 512 \end{bmatrix} \times 8$
conv4_x	14×14	$\begin{bmatrix} 3 \times 3, 256 \\ 3 \times 3, 256 \end{bmatrix} \times 2$	$\begin{bmatrix} 3 \times 3, 256 \\ 3 \times 3, 256 \end{bmatrix} \times 6$	$\begin{bmatrix} 1 \times 1, 256 \\ 3 \times 3, 256 \\ 1 \times 1, 1024 \end{bmatrix} \times 6$	$\begin{bmatrix} 1 \times 1, 256 \\ 3 \times 3, 256 \\ 1 \times 1, 1024 \end{bmatrix} \times 23$	$\begin{bmatrix} 1 \times 1, 256 \\ 3 \times 3, 256 \\ 1 \times 1, 1024 \end{bmatrix} \times 36$
conv5_x	7×7	$\begin{bmatrix} 3 \times 3, 512 \\ 3 \times 3, 512 \end{bmatrix} \times 2$	$\begin{bmatrix} 3 \times 3, 512 \\ 3 \times 3, 512 \end{bmatrix} \times 3$	$\begin{bmatrix} 1 \times 1, 512 \\ 3 \times 3, 512 \\ 1 \times 1, 2048 \end{bmatrix} \times 3$	$\begin{bmatrix} 1 \times 1, 512 \\ 3 \times 3, 512 \\ 1 \times 1, 2048 \end{bmatrix} \times 3$	$\begin{bmatrix} 1 \times 1, 512 \\ 3 \times 3, 512 \\ 1 \times 1, 2048 \end{bmatrix} \times 3$
	1×1	average pool, 1000-d fc, softmax				
FLOPs		1.8×10^9	3.6×10^9	3.8×10^9	7.6×10^9	11.3×10^9

Uses Basic Residual Block

Uses Bottleneck Residual Block

Experimental Results

■ Training ResNet:

- Batch Normalization after every CONV layer
- Xavier initialization from He et al.
- SGD + Momentum (0.9)
- Learning rate = 0.1, divided by 10 when validation error plateaus
- Mini-batch size 128
- Weight decay of $1e-5$
- No dropout used

■ Experimental results

- Able to train very deep network without degradation (152 layers on ImageNet, 1202 layers on CIFAR10)
- Deeper networks can achieve lower training error as expected
- 1st place in all ILSVRC and COCO 2015 competitions

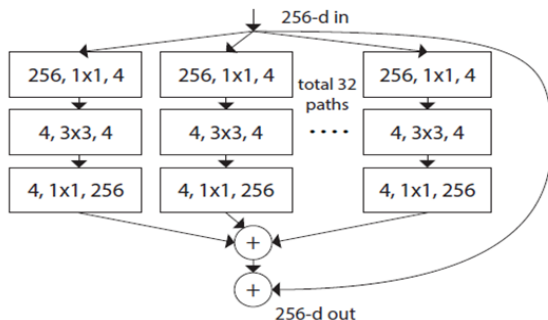
Network Architecture: **ResNeXt**

ResNeXt (2017)

Xie, S., Girshick, R., Dollár, P., Tu, Z. and He, K., 2017. Aggregated residual transformations for deep neural networks. In *Proceedings of the IEEE conference on computer vision and pattern recognition* (pp. 1492-1500).

- Similar overall structure as ResNet but uses **ResNeXt** layers which processes the input in different **paths** or **groups**.
 - Each path has **fewer** channels (e.g., 4) → more efficient.
 - Each path learns **different** types of features independently → more diverse representations and better generalization
- No of paths = **cardinality** of the network. **32x4d** means cardinality=32, channels=4

A ResNeXt block (32x4d)



Operations of ResNeXt Block

- Same input goes to multiple paths
- For each path:
 - Shrink channels with CONV1x1
 - Perform CONV3x3 (efficient since channels have been reduced)
 - Revive channels with CONV1x1
- Merge paths by adding activations from all paths

- Often **outperforms** ResNet on **large-scale** datasets, e.g., ImageNet. But not necessarily so on small-scale datasets or certain tasks.

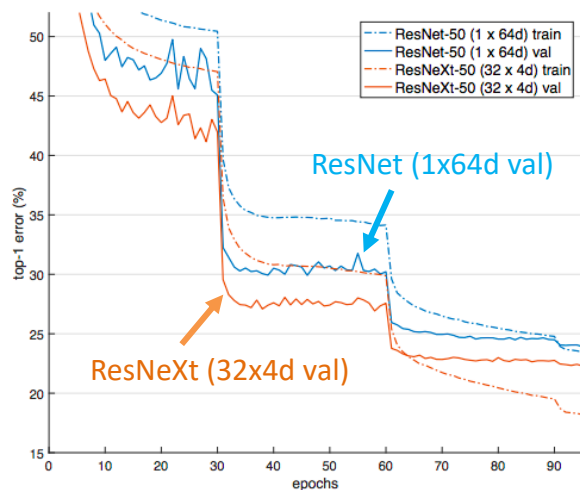
Why having multiple groups work better?

- **Independent learning path** – capture different aspects of the data more efficiently. Prevent issues such as co-adaptation.
- **Enhanced expressive power** –splitting convolution into multiple groups and combining the outputs allows the network to learn a richer and more diverse set of representation.
- **Efficient Use of Parameters** – increase network capacity without increasing the computational cost linearly.
- **Improved gradient flow** – gradients from each group propagate more independently.

ResNeXt (2017)

- Replacing ResNet layers with ResNeXt layers often improves the performance of the model.

Depth = 50



Depth = 101

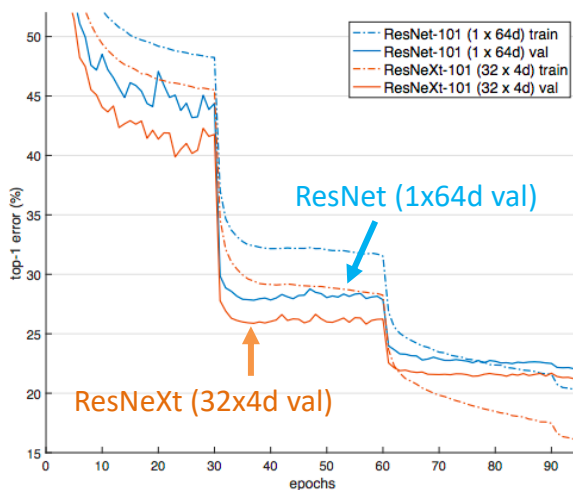


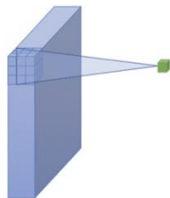
Figure 5. Training curves on ImageNet-1K. (Left): ResNet/ResNeXt-50 with preserved complexity (~ 4.1 billion FLOPs, ~ 25 million parameters); (Right): ResNet/ResNeXt-101 with preserved complexity (~ 7.8 billion FLOPs, ~ 44 million parameters).

Network Architecture: **MobileNet**

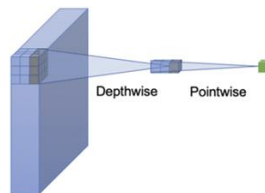
MobileNet

(Howard, Andrew G., et al., [Mobilenets: Efficient convolutional neural networks for mobile vision applications](#). 2017)

- **Efficient** deep learning model for **mobile** and **edge** devices
- Replaces standard convolutions with **Depthwise Separable Convolution** → fewer parameters, lower computation and comparable accuracy

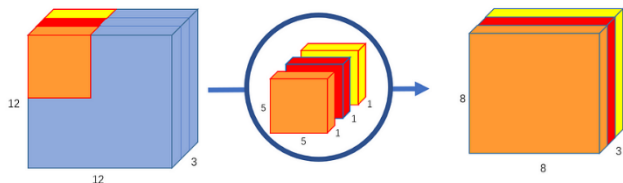


Standard Convolution

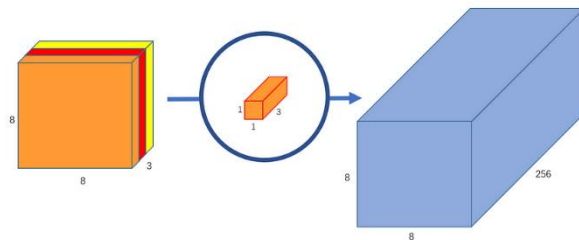


Depth-wise Separable Convolution

- Depthwise Separable Convolution splits spatial filtering and feature combination:

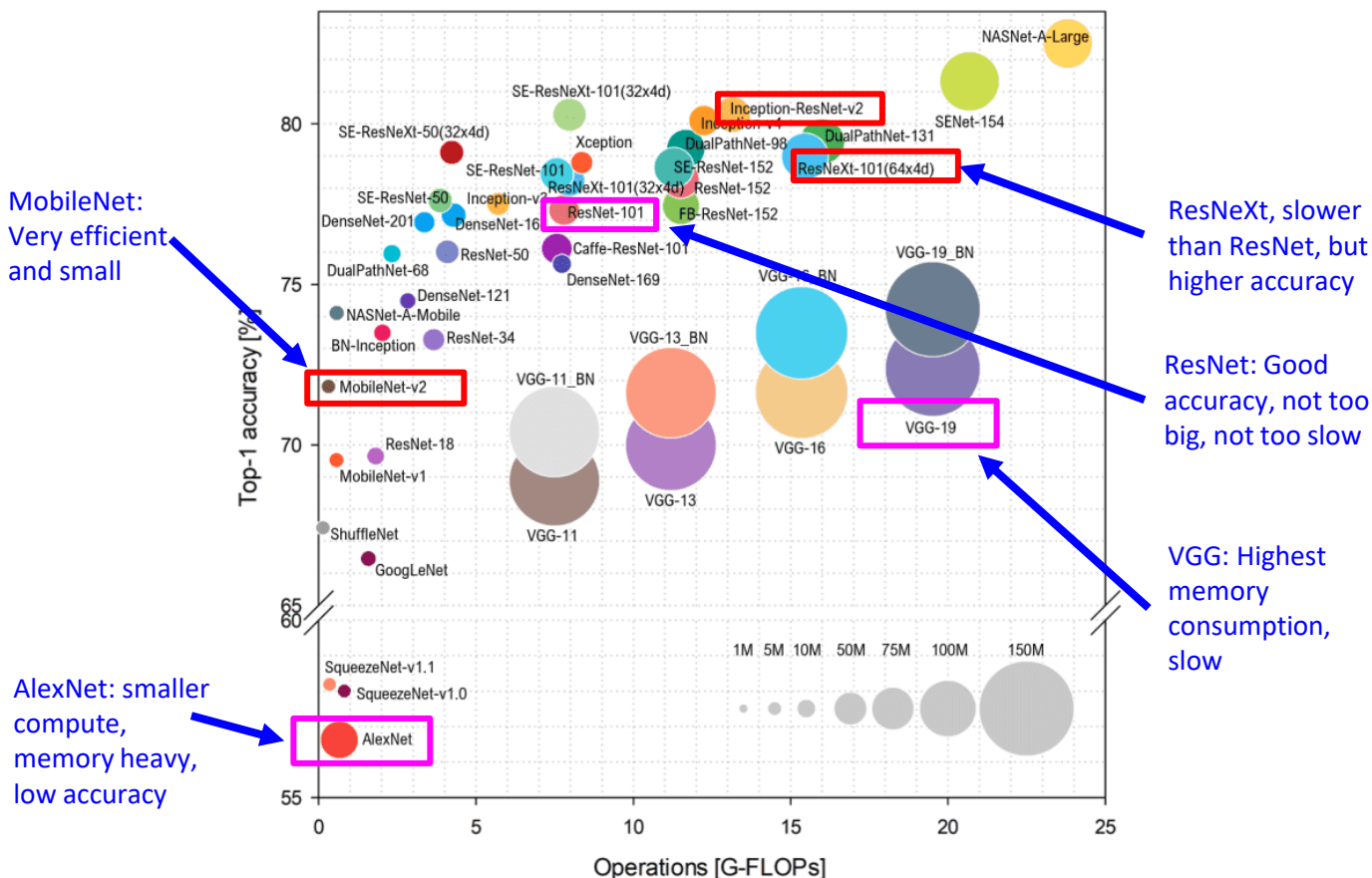


Depth-wise convolution: Applies a single filter per input channel with $c_f = 1$ to capture spatial features.



Point-wise convolution: Uses 1x1 convolutions with $c_f = c_{in}$ to combine channel information.

Performance of CNN Architectures



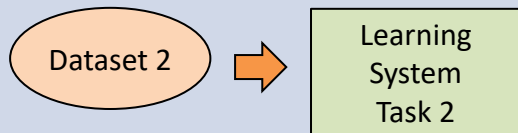
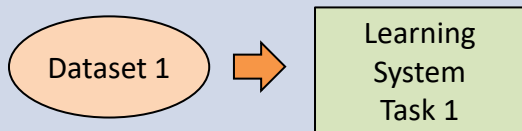
Source: Simone Bianco et al. 2018

Transfer Learning

Transfer learning

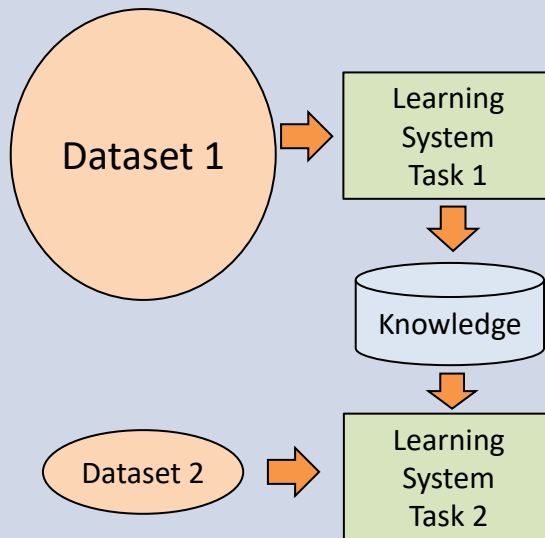
Traditional ML

- Isolated single task learning
- Knowledge is not retained
- Easily overfit if dataset is small



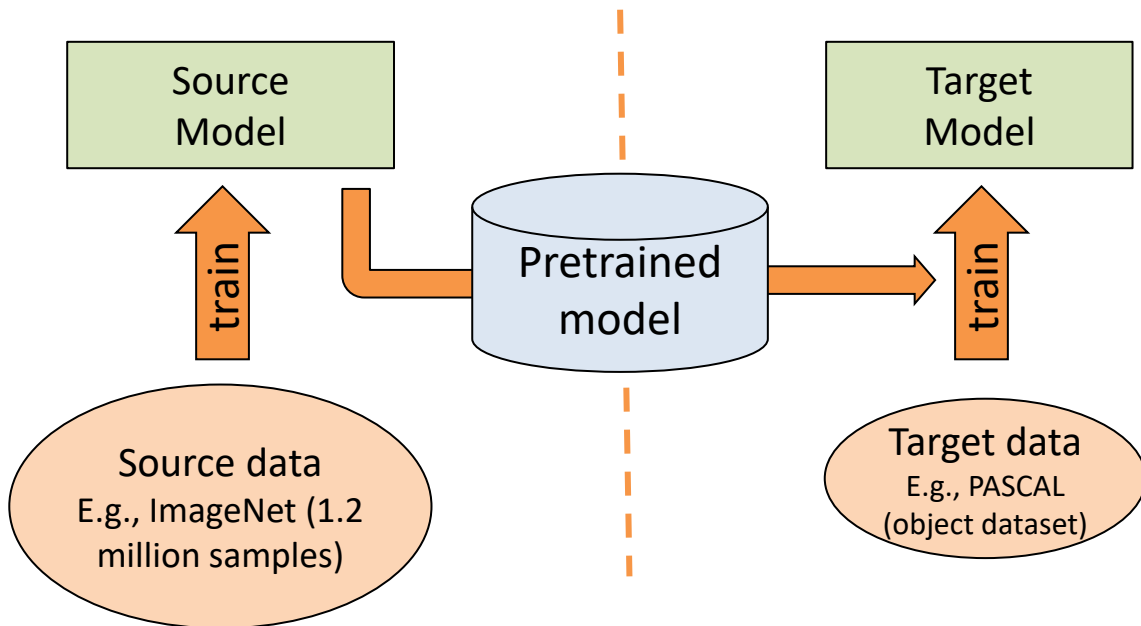
Transfer Learning

- New task is learnt on top of previously learnt task
- Improves generalization of new task even for small training set



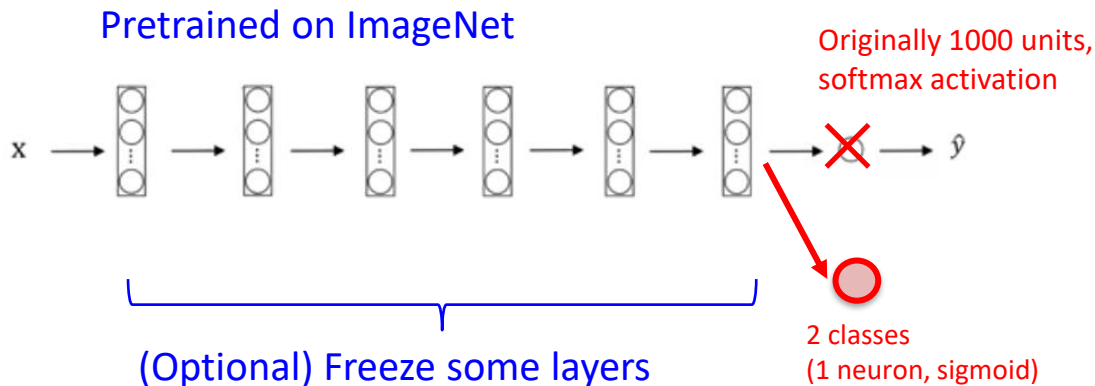
Transfer learning

- Instead of training from scratch
 - Takes a network trained on a different domain and **source task** (with many annotated training samples)
 - Adapt it to your domain and **targeted task**



Adapting a pre-trained model

To adapt a pre-trained model, replace the classification layer. Then, retrain the model (can opt to freeze some layers if overfitting occurs)

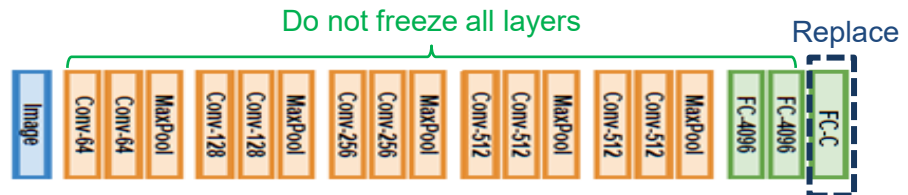
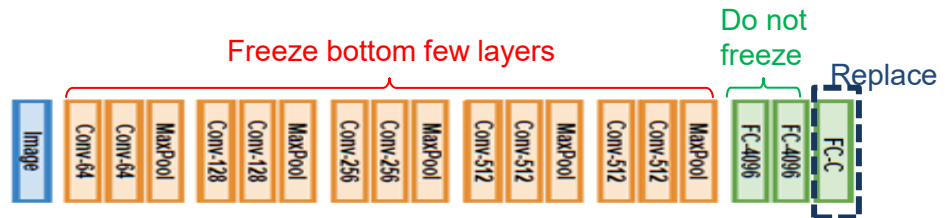
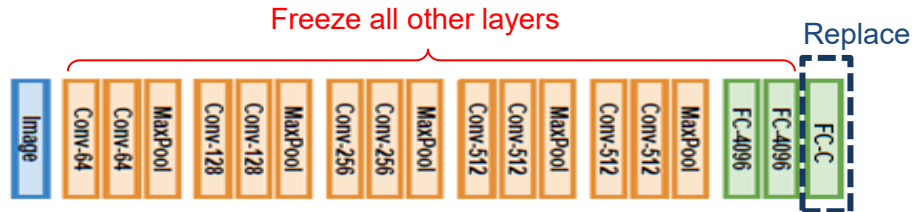


② Train the model with the targeted training set

① Replace the classification layer

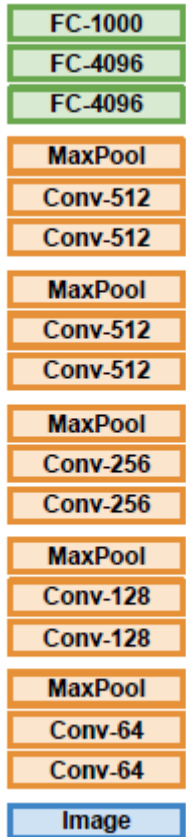
Feature extractor vs fine-tuning

- For small dataset, use as **feature extractor** → reduces overfitting
- For medium dataset, **finetune a few** top layers (top layers are more class specific)
- For large dataset, **finetune all** layers



When fine-tuning, use a lower learning rate, e.g., 1/10 of original LR

How many layers to finetune?



More
class
specific

More class
agnostic
(general)

- Features in the deeper layers are more class **specific**
- Features in the shallower layers are more class **agnostic** (general)
- How many (top) layers to finetune?

	Very similar dataset	Very different dataset
Targeted dataset is small	Use pre-trained model as feature extractor	You're in trouble... Try linear classifier from different stages
Targeted dataset is big	Finetune a few top layers	Finetune the whole network

Benefits of Transfer learning

- Transfers the knowledge from one domain to another
- Training on a pre-trained model can improve the result significantly
- Allow us to achieve very good result even with a very small data set.
- Deep learning frameworks provide a "Model Zoo" of pretrained models so that you do not have to train your own.

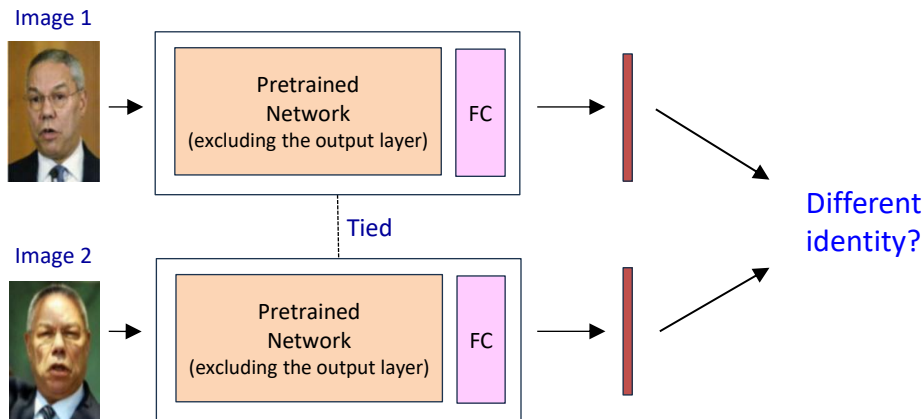
PyTorch: <https://pytorch.org/vision/stable/models.html>

Applications: Face Recognition

Siamese Network for Contrastive Task

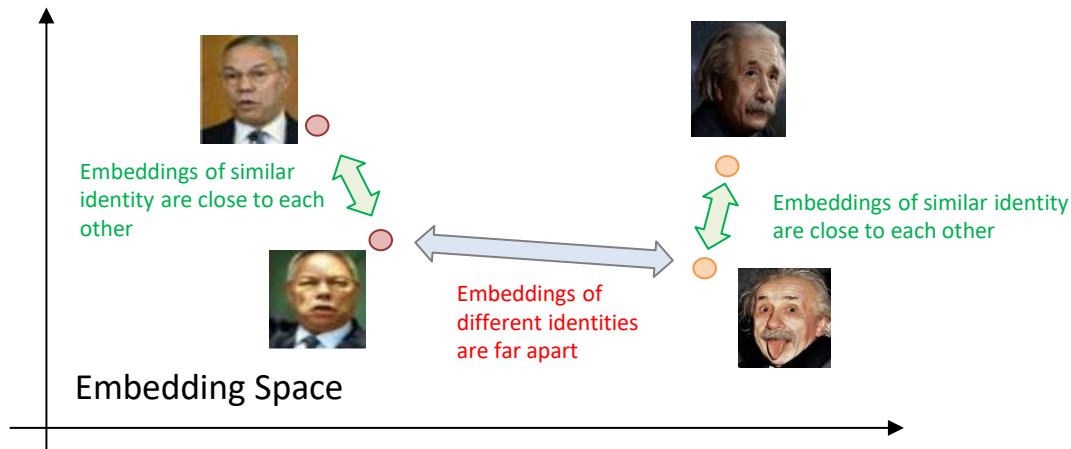
[Schroff, F., et al. [Facenet: A unified embedding for face recognition and clustering](#). CVPR 2015.]

- **Goal:** Determine if two face images belong to the same identity
- **Architecture:** Two **identical** neural networks (**shared weights**) extracts the feature vector (embedding) for each image.



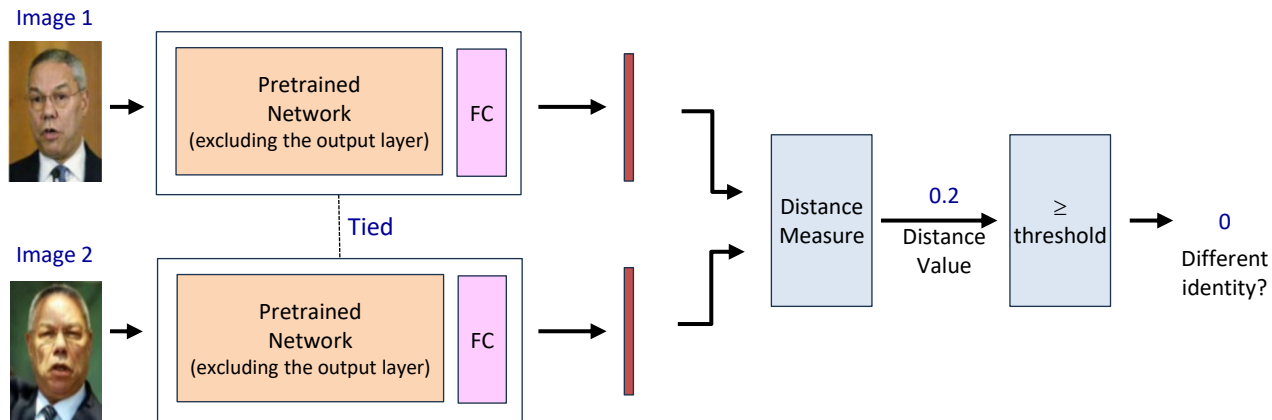
- Use a **pretrained network** (e.g., ResNet34) is used to extract the feature
- Use a **custom FC** to project the extracted feature into embedding vector.
- **Compare** the two embedding vectors: Different identities?

Face recognition in the Embedding Space



- The embedding vector resides in an **embedding space**
- Compare the **distance** to determine identity
 - Small distance: same identity
 - Large distance: different identity
- Learns **similarity**, not classification
 - Works well with **limited data**
 - Easily generalizes to **new identity**

Process Flow



- ① **Input:** two images
- ② Uses the twin networks to extract embeddings (e.g., 128-D vector) for both images
- ③ Compute distance (Euclidean or cosine distance)
- ④ Apply threshold
 - **Small distance** → same person (label = 0)
 - **Large distance** → Different person (label = 1)

Training with Contrastive Loss

- The loss function learn embeddings where **same** identity are close together and **different** identities far apart.
- **Contrastive Loss:**

$$L = (1 - y)D^2 + y \max(0, m - D)^2$$

D : distance between embeddings

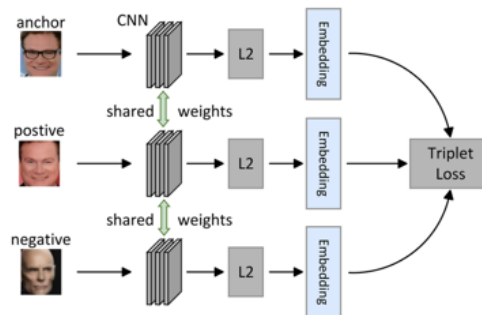
$y = 0$ (same person), $y = 1$ (different person)

m : margin

- The first term **pulls** similar pairs closer
- The second term **pushes** dissimilar parts apart beyond the margin.
- **Weakness:** Contrastive loss treats pairs **independently**, so it doesn't enforce **relative ordering** between similar and dissimilar samples.

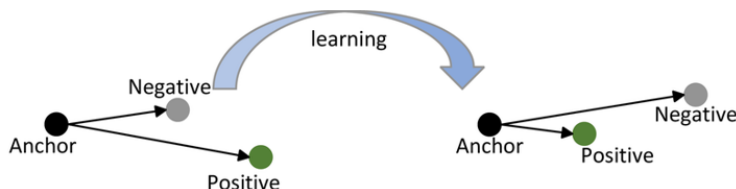
Training with Triplet Loss

- **Triplet Loss** trains **three** images
- Ensures an **anchor** image is closer to a **positive** (same identity) image than to a **negative** (different identity) image by a **margin**.



$$L = \max (0, D(a, p) - D(a, n) + m)$$

D : distance between embeddings
 a : anchor,
 p : positive (same identity)
 n : negative (different identity)
 m : margin



- Enforces **relative ordering**, ensuring each anchor is closer to its positive than to any negative, producing better-separated embeddings.

Training with Triplet Loss

- Requires **careful sampling** of informative
 - Compute full pair-wise distances and select hardest / semi-hard
 - **Hard negative**: Negative closer than the positive
 - **Semi-hard negative**: Farther than positive but within margin
 - **Easy** : Farther than positive and out of margin
- Use **large batch size**
 - At least 32-128 images
 - More negatives to choose from
 - Sample P identities x K images each (e.g., 8x4)
- Apply **curriculum strategy**
 - Avoid only hardest samples early → can destabilize training
 - **Early** training: mostly **random** or **semi-hard**
 - **Later** training: use more **hard** negatives
- Distance measure
 - Recommendation: **L2-normalized** embedding + **cosine** similarity

*Thank you
for your attention*